Cowabunga

SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

TUE NOV 3, 2026

DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · TUE NOV 3 · NORTH PB

It is about as big as yesterday with a long-period west swell, so skip the heavy beach break and paddle out at Tourmaline around eight. Surf it until about

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Tourmaline

WINDOW	8–11:30a · Anvil twin · ~75°F
SURF	3–5 ft (SRF), W 18s + SSW 14–15s groundswell, sets bigger on the open beach
TIDE	H 4.6 @ 5:22a L 2.0 @ 11:04a H 4.6 @ 4:42p L 0.3 @ 11:17p obs 6.0 @ 5:48a

eleven thirty, before the northwest wind shows up at noon.

Long period means bigger sets than the buoy says.

Big west swell: Tourmaline, the soft option

PADDLE OUT BY	8:00	BOARD Anvil twin ~75°F WATER

8 /10

SURF RATING · GOOD · LIVE

Very good — move a meeting

capped by swell 3.9 ft · Better than 82% of 51 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

3-5 FT (SRF), W 18S + SSW 14-15S GROUNDSWELL, SETS BIGGER ON THE OPEN BEACH

GROUND

SwH 3.3–4.3 ft · 14–18s

WINDSWELL

WWH 2.3 ft · 7–10s

HS BUOY

Hs 3.9–4.9 ft · 46258

FROM

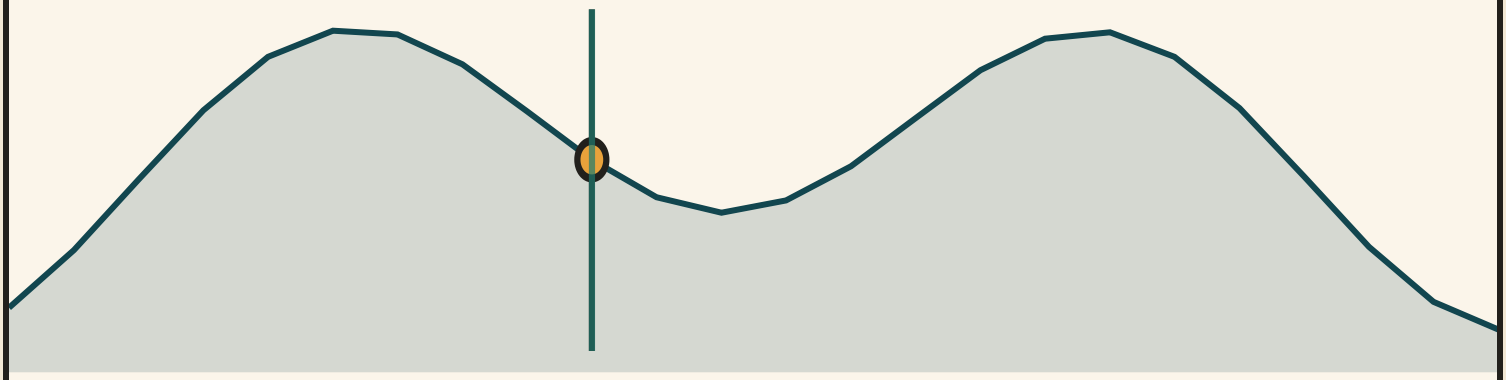
270° W + SSW

Buoy 46258 · Hs 3.9–4.9 ft (spectrum SwH 3.3–4.3 ft @ 14–18s, W 270° + SSW 205°) + WWH 2.3 ft @ 7–10s · face 3–5 ft (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 SW 3 ft @ 15s + W 2 ft @ 7s · wind E 7 kt at 5a, N 5 mph to 10a, NW 10 mph from noon

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

6–8A · FULL TIDE, OPEN BEACH CLOSING OUT ON W SETS	8–11:30A · TOURMALINE, LIGHT N WIND, TIDE FALLING	NOON–DARK · NW 10 MPH, BUMPY
MEH	GO	SKIP



9:00a	Tourmaline, light N wind, tide falling toward the 11:04a low	2.8 ft tide	N ~4 kt, sunny · NWS	3–5 ft (SRF), W 18s + SSW 14–15s groundswell, sets bigger on the open beach

H 4.6 @ 5:22a · L 2.0 @ 11:04a · H 4.6 @ 4:42p · L 0.3 @ 11:17p · obs 6.0 @ 5:48a

Tourmaline from about 8 to 11:30a on the Anvil twin. Table tides: H 4.6 @ 5:22a, L 2.0 @ 11:04a, H 4.6 @ 4:42p, L 0.3 @ 11:17p. The gauge read 6.0 ft at 5:48a, about 1.4 ft over the table (the SRF says 1.3 to 1.5 ft), so the late-morning low only reaches about 3.4 ft. LJAC1 was E 7 kt at 5:18a. NWS hourly has calm to N 5 mph and sunny through 10a, NW 5 mph at 11a and NW 10 mph from noon. PZZ740 calls NW 10 to 15 kt today, so the afternoon goes bumpy.

Where it's working

Tourmaline · 8–11:30a

Same size as yesterday, but the main swell turned W at 18 seconds (46258 SwH 1.1–1.3 m, 3.6–4.3 ft, with SSW 14–15s underneath). That much long-period energy makes the open beach heavy and closeout-prone, which is past your fish comfort zone. Tourmaline is the softer, more rolling wave on this stretch. The tide drops off the very full morning high (gauge 6.0 ft at 5:48a, about 1.4 ft over the table) toward the 11:04a low, which reads about 3.4 ft real, and the wind stays light N (NWS N 5 mph to 10a) until NW 10 mph fills in at noon. Scorecard at 10:30a: 0.98.

CALL

Also fine · PB north of pier, 8:30–10:30a

Top raw score (0.98 forecast at 8a), but the W sets close out harder there. Only if Tourmaline is a zoo and you are fine with head-high-plus sets.

ALSO OK

Blacks (extended) · beyond the fish

Live score 0.95 on 46225 (SwH 3.6 ft @ 15s SSW), past the drive margin on paper. The canyon will turn an 18 second W swell into well overhead sets, so it needs a shortboard you do not own yet. Skip it on the Anvil.

BEYOND

Skip · Little Point (drowned until about 9:30a and on a falling tide after), PB Point and Calumet on this tide, the Drive (long-period closeouts), anything after the NW wind at noon.

SKIP

BOARD

Anvil twin

~75°F

QUIVER

Anvil twin fish

Good on the softer Tourmaline walls. The bigger W sets at the open beach or Blacks want a shortboard you do not own yet.

TW log · too much size and too crowded with logs at Tourmaline today

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Long period means bigger sets than the buoy says.

An 18 second swell carries far more energy than a 10 second one of the same height, because the water moves much deeper below the surface. When it reaches shallow sand it stands up fast and steep, so a 4 ft buoy reading can turn into head-high-plus sets with long lulls in between. Spots with a gentler bottom, like the Tourmaline reef and cobble, slow that down and make it softer.

SKIP

The open beach (PB north, the Drive) at the full early tide, where the 18 second W sets close out. Little Point on a falling tide. Blacks on the Anvil. Everything once NW 10 mph fills in around noon.

GOTCHAS

Size: SRF 3 to 5 ft with long-period W sets, so expect long lulls and then sets well bigger than the average. Be patient and sit wide. Tourmaline crowd: packed with longboards and beginners, so watch for loose boards. High rip current risk (NWS SRF). Water: the county rain advisory from Sunday covers 72 hours after rain, so it runs out about today; stay away from outlets.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL · Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES